

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Seyit Tolga Ingenc

Address: 360 Malden Road Cheam SM3 8HB

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: As a local resident, I am writing to support planning application DM2025/01591. I think this proposal deserves approval and will explain my reasons below.

Objectors have raised concerns about parking, but the evidence does not support them. The Transport Statement shows 269 on-street spaces within 400 metres of the site, with under 50% utilisation at peak times. Even adding the maximum predicted visitors, there is still comfortable headroom before parking stress becomes an issue.

In addition, compared to the former ambulance station, which ran 24 hours a day with emergency vehicles and sirens at all hours, the proposed use is much calmer. Operating hours are restricted, there are no large vehicles, and the activities are community-based rather than emergency-response. Neighbours will notice the difference.

It is also worth mentioning that some objectors have raised concerns about late-night disturbance, but the operating hours are restricted and the programming shows activities spread across the daytime hours. This is not a late-night venue.

The application shows a clear and growing need for this type of facility in the area. This proposal addresses an obvious gap. The demographic evidence is compelling, and the existing provision is simply not sufficient.

GPs increasingly refer patients to community activities as part of social prescribing. But that only works if there are local facilities to refer to. This proposal would create one in an area that

currently has very little.

In addition, the proportion driving alone is very low. Based on actual travel surveys of the existing congregation, the majority of users walk to worship. This means the impact on local parking and traffic is much smaller than objectors seem to assume.

It is also worth mentioning that I welcome the fact that this proposal goes beyond faith provision to include a genuine community hub. The wellbeing sessions, drop-ins, and educational programmes will serve the whole neighbourhood and help build a more connected community.

Moreover, there is no temporal overlap between Friday prayer times and the school run at Avenue Primary Academy. Prayers are at midday; the school run is morning and mid-afternoon. This concern, while understandable, is not founded on the actual timings.

I ask the London Borough of Sutton to approve application DM2025/01591. It is well-planned, policy-compliant, and will bring tangible benefit to the community.